LEGACY

Open source

Grammar in context

1 A) What open source projects do you know? What do they produce or solve? Which ones does your team or company use?

2 🔊 LISTEN. Listen to the podcast interview. Which sentence best illustrates the topic?

a. A developer working alone on a private codebase.

b. A distributed team contributing to a shared repository.

c. A corporation buying a software license.

d. A single company maintaining a product in secret.

DEVTALK PODCAST: The future of open source development

Maya By 2030, it's estimated that over 90% of companies will rely on open source software in some part of their stack. That's a striking number — especially if the development models we use today continue as they are. Experts say something must change if software is going to remain sustainable and secure. That's why the future of open source is being discussed at a major developer conference this week. Andrés Villanueva, our open source correspondent, joins me. Andrés, what exactly is open source software, and where did the idea come from?

Andrés The idea was developed by a group of engineers and activists in the late 1990s. Open source software is basically code that can be inspected, modified, and distributed by anyone. So projects will be built in public — in shared repositories, instead of private codebases.

Maya And what are the advantages of building software this way?

Andrés Well, supporters say it's more reliable because bugs won't be hidden by a single company — they'll be spotted and fixed by the community. It's also more secure, because the code can be audited by anyone at any time. And because contributions will be made, reviewed, and merged by developers around the world, the pace of innovation can be greatly accelerated. So in theory, software should be better and cheaper to maintain, too.

3 PAIR WORK. Answer the questions about the interview.

1. -Why is the future of open source an important topic right now?

Tu respuesta...

2. -What will open source projects look like? Where will they be built?

Tu respuesta...

3. **-In what ways is open source development different from proprietary software development?**

Tu respuesta...

4. **-Why will open source software probably be cheaper to maintain?**

Tu respuesta...

Grammar — Information focus

4 **Figure it out. How does the interview express the ideas below? Rewrite the sentences, starting with the words given. Use the interview to help you. Then read the grammar chart.**

A group of engineers and activists developed the idea in the late 1990s. (The idea...)

Tu respuesta...

Developers will build projects in public. (Projects...)

Tu respuesta...

A single company won't hide bugs. (Bugs...)

Tu respuesta...

The passive

You can use the passive to make the "receiver" of an action the focus, when you don't know the "doer," or when the "doer" is not important. You can introduce the "doer" with *by*.

ACTIVE SENTENCES	PASSIVE SENTENCES
Teams **use** *open source software.*	*Open source software* **is used** *by teams.*
A group of engineers and activists **developed** *the idea.*	*The idea* **was developed** *by a group of engineers and activists.*
Open source communities **haven't solved** *every sustainability issue yet.*	*Not every sustainability issue* **has been solved** *yet.*
Conference organizers **are going to discuss** *the future of open source.*	*The future of open source* **is going to be discussed** *at the conference.*
Developers **will build** *projects in public.*	*Projects* **will be built** *in public.*
A single company **won't hide** *bugs.*	*Bugs* **won't be hidden** *by a single company.*
Anyone **can audit** *the code at any time.*	*The code* **can be audited** *by anyone at any*

time.

5 **Read the rest of the interview. Then complete the passive versions of the ideas below. Use the grammar chart to help you. Then check your answers with a partner.**

Example: projects will be built

01

A So teams use open source software now. Does that mean developers will build projects in public?

B In many cases, yes. That makes it easier for people outside the original team to see how a project develops.

1. Open source software _____ by teams. Projects _____ in public.

02

A What are some of the challenges?

B Well, open source communities haven't solved every sustainability issue yet. And conference organizers are going to discuss the future of open source this week.

2. Not every sustainability issue _____ yet. The future of open source _____ at the conference.

03

A And what about security? Is public code necessarily less secure?

B Not necessarily. A single company won't hide bugs in the same way, and anyone can audit the code at any time.

3. Bugs _____ by a single company. The code _____ by anyone at any time.

GROUP WORK **Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of open source software. Use the passive when the action or result is more important than the person who does it.**

"One advantage is that the code **can be audited** *by anyone."*

"Also, projects **will be built** *in public, so bugs* **won't be hidden** *by a single company."*

"Yes, but not every sustainability issue **has been solved** *yet, so projects still need good governance."*